

Mott Foundation/21st Century Learning. They host a discussion group centered around the 21st century grants.

Steve, I think you'd be in a better position than I to engage local and national partners to the effort. You are better at building a team. I'm out front leading the team (and recruiting new members).

(others we seek financial, human, and in-kind support)

1) Technology partners - we need to offer a carrot and stick to potential program partners. If we could put a computer, and 10 hrs/week in staff dollars to operate it, into a couple of dozen sites around Chicago, we could probably "buy" some partnership, and provide the tools for them to get into the conversation at the same time.

2) Business and trade associations. Our target for this on-line system is not just non-profits, it is the business community. These are the people looking for schools to produce better-prepared workers and for government to reduce the high cost of poverty and violence.

Include tertiary partners who we will connect with to avoid duplication of efforts, America's Promise, NMP, National Mentor Foundation,....

Unique Contributions and Potential Implications

However, our ability to turn their needs into curriculum, using their volunteers, technology, ideas and leadership, will enable tutor/mentor programs to better prepare students to fill these needs. As we demonstrate an effectiveness in this area we should be able to draw on-going flows of revenue from these industries to support our work.

Summary

1998-2004 Tutor/Mentor Connection collaboration with Steve Roussos, U Kansas PhD student in 1998

Steve introduced himself prior to the Nov. 1998 conference and I invited him to be a speaker. That started a relationship with strong collaboration on grants, web site development and the OHATS documentation system, which was strongest from 1998-2004. The relationship continues in 2019.

This is collection of email in 1999. Many focus on development of two government grants.

Budget

References

Hi Dan,

This could be a great opportunity to take the conferences to the next level which would add more applied skill-building workshops to the "here's what we did and why we like it" type presentations (though BOTH are needed in a conference). Based on what you say about the evaluations I believe that over the years you may have built a following of folks who have developed to the point of needing more advanced training. That is a sign of success!

3 things that may help (and I will put the word out to search for folks in Chicago that could be your conference coordinator).

1. Finding a conference coordinator -- Call the coordinator of the Learning Annex or other type community publication; here in Kansas it's called Community Learner. This publication is free and widely distributed. It is full of workshops and classes from anything like learning to cook meals in under 10 minutes, to exercise classes, to starting your own business. The important thing about such groups is they focus on teaching skills. The coordinator of such a publication likely knows people with experience in organizing conferences and may be looking for some work but not full-time. They may even know of a conference coordinating group that does conferences for a living and could take up T/MC for less cost.

2. Workshop speakers -- (I'll check with Paul and Derek for this too, since they will both be in Chicago for the next conference I cannot see why they could not present one or two workshops).

- a. Also ask the Learning Annex coordinator for help with speakers since their main job is to coordinate workshops. The main difference is that they may want to charge for them or get a small stipend, but they may donate their services. They may have people who work with and organize volunteers and even do workshops specific to tutor/mentor/school-to-work programs.

- b. It would be great to go to know who wrote the most critical and useful comments on the evaluations since they could be someone that knows enough to want something better and be a potential workshop speaker. One thing we could do is take speakers from past conferences and help them become more focused on teaching skills or turning their presentation into a hands-on workshop. If this seems like an option, I could work with people to turn their presentation into a workshop by giving them some feedback and training by phone.

3. It would be nice to turn the tables around so that instead of searching for workshop presenters each year the workshop presenters come searching for us. This may not decrease the workload but it will make it different. One thing some professional association do for conferences that I attend is to have a "call for speakers/presenters." This is a competition of sorts where people all over the country who are part of this group (like me) send in an application to present on a certain topic or category (broad categories are selected by the conference group). Judges select the winning applicants who get the opportunity to do their thing at the conference (for free) for the honor of being able to share with their professional peers. Sometimes there is a prize for most useful presentation or other prize category. This process of sending invitations out, judging them, etc can take between 4 to 6-months.

One more idea came to mind. One of the things foundations are receptive to funding is conferences like the T/MC conference. I see this often in the annual reports. It would be great to come up with a total conference cost and separate cost of certain pieces of the conference. We could write a letter to MacArthur (separate or include it in the Learning

Network proposal) and to the Chicago Community Trust specific for conference money. This way we could have it at a nice hotel and potentially pay for better speakers without raising the price too much.

That's all for now, Steve

-----Original Message-----
From: Daniel Bassill

Hi Dan,

I managed to fit all I could, including key comments from your UPS proposal and "implementation comments" in to the maximum allowed space of 7 double-spaced pages (this meant cutting 2 entire pages out). When we make it to the next stage we can go all out with our ideas in 25 pages. Then I say we include the Total Quality Mentoring Model and Diagram. You might want to look at this version again and maybe add this draft to the final UPS proposal. Changes were throughout but most were in the following sections: learning strategies, implementation plan, evaluation.

Here are all parts of the FIPSE grant proposal that should be reaching your home on Thursday (hopefully before 12). I hope the formatting comes out well when you open them up. The final attachment is an Excel version of the budget that will not be sent to FIPSE, but helped me see the overall picture. I have a feeling this budget will change quite a bit as we put in the specific costs and cost-shares of other partners.

I'll send my revisions to the UPS draft you sent me to your home email this evening. So far it looks great!
Enjoy, Steve

ubject:

FIPSE funding

Date:

Wed, 05 May 1999 20:22:44 -0500

From:

Stergios Russos <russo@KUHUB.CC.UKANS.EDU>

To:

"Daniel Bassill" <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>

Hi Dan,

Today I received a postcard from FIPSE saying they received our Anytime, Anywhere Learning grant proposal. This reminded me that we need to start looking for matching funds for our \$200,000 plus per year budget. Though I mentioned our plans to expand our Internet-based services, I forgot to specifically ask for a "match" in an email I sent yesterday to a contact at Kauffman. So just a reminder, start asking folks if they would be willing to "match" some portion of the federal money we asked for, IF we do get funded. The important thing here is to ask folks to support the Learning Network contingent on getting the FIPSE grant. This might be more attractive or easier to commit to for some funders. Of course, if we don't get the grant they could always decide to support us anyway.

We'll know if we can send in a final proposal sometime early in June, but it would be great to have some potential supporters ahead of that time. I can't say for sure what our chances are, but I believe we sent in a pretty good preliminary proposal (though an expensive one).

This weekend I'll begin breaking out the FIPSE grant budget into more specific categories and needs that we can ask people to support.

Enjoy, Steve

To:

"tutormentor2@earthlink.net" <tutormentor2@earthlink.net>

Congratulations on the grants coming in! Also, great publicity of T/MC's value and leadership on the Bar's web page. It clearly shows the value of the T/MC - Bar relationship.

I'm glad the conversation with Knowledge Circles went well. I was impressed with their site. If they'd be willing to help out we could begin the discussions soon and connect the Knowledge Circle to the T/MC web site.

Matt
Knowledge
Circles
Face 6/18/00

I received my T/MC evaluations back for my Evaluation Workshop today (Thanks!). I won't let them go to my head, but the responses were fantastic! Many people asked for the workshop to be longer so that they could learn more. I must admit, humbly, it was one of the better evaluation workshops and the audience was very active and engaged. I believe many left with something they could use right away. I am tempted to suggest I do two workshops on evaluation next time or depending on how things are arranged I could do a longer workshop that will take people more thoroughly through an evaluation of a project. It was a bit rushed at the end. Another idea, which I'm not exactly sure how we would do yet, is to help build an evaluation function/technical assistance within T/MC. Possibly, with Paul and Derek in Chicago, but ideally one full-time person, a system could be set up for people to pool their resources together for evaluating their progress. This will take some more thinking, but I sensed that many programs need/are hungry for and lacking help in (and money for) practical evaluation. The Learning Network proposal builds in some self-evaluation for users, but most programs will need a bit of extra one-on-one help. More thoughts on this later. [Would it be possible to put my evaluation workshop handouts and worksheets on the T/MC page for others to download?]

Here's a rough idea of the major events (besides daily work) in my life before I leave Kansas:

This Thursday turn in a full draft of my review paper on collaborative partnerships in public health to my advisor (this will be my main focus for June since it's due to the editors July 1).

June, finalize who will be on my dissertation committee (this is the 'story' of how YouthFriends developed and results to date. My analyses should describe some fascinating lessons of how a volunteer initiative goes "to-scale" and how implications for how T/MC-type organizations work -- though YF is not really a T/MC)

June 14-16: YouthFriends mini-conference. Presentation of evaluation results to date.

June 17 - 20: Visit Pennsylvania to look for housing and meet potential work mates (Looks like there are some possibilities with a local foundation, a consulting group and a hospital research team. Ideally I can do some consulting to pay our bills while having some flexibility with my time.).

July 18: Fly out to California -- get married July 31. Honeymoon and move out to Pennsylvania middle of August.

I'll mail you the MacArthur proposal this weekend. I bet we can mail it out first week of June. I must say I'm just a little nervous since no one has joined in our excitement about the Learning Network. I want to make sure the MacArthur proposal succeeds, even

if it is to start a relationship with T/MC. I'm crossing my fingers UPS or Motorola respond favorably. Regardless what happens, I am confident our ideas are sound (though they could always be improved) and we are on the right track. Somebody will listen eventually. I only wish I had a bit more time to dedicate to this now.

Besides the MacArthur proposal here's some other work I'd like to get done this summer:

1. Complete list of specific roles/tasks/opportunities within development of the Learning Network so we can find folks to fill the niches.
2. Contact Bob at Sprint about any funding leads/collaboration for mapping.
3. Connect with Mott/send proposal for Learning Network.
4. Discuss/Lay out what it would take to understand and improve the past and ongoing function of T/MC (for me this would begin with training you and having you start documenting T/MC's "community change" each month -- fairly simple). This would be used as a model for other T/MC's to understand and improve their efforts.
5. As you see fit, lay out a plan for building in an evaluation capacity for Chicago tutor-mentor programs using the maps and community change data to start.
6. Lay out some specific ways to build-in income generation for T/MC besides soft-grant money. This may start with getting a percentage off the credit-card-type counting system for volunteer and student activities. This also could be a great start to pooling basic evaluation results (participation numbers).

How that sound? Anything you'd like to add?

Onwards and upwards, Steve

Measures of development of new programs and expansion/strengthening of existing ones.

Anticipated Challenges and Potential Solutions

Lack technology access -

Lack technology skills -

Fellowships, scholarships

Tech Team

The Learning System's Collaborating Partners

[Dan, let's discuss this section by phone. I'd love to take the lead on this but I want to make sure this will be useful to you given that I do not live in Chicago (wow the real test of distance, internet based work) and I want to position it in such a way that I can still do some of the evaluation. I'm not sure how much this grant want "outside" evaluators who would not benefit from the program's success. We could work it out where I lead both, but not conduct the evaluation directly.]

["Your narrative should offer reviewers a clear description of the roles to be played by each of the partners, who will do what, when, and where, to what ends, and with what anticipated results. Your strategies should be carefully designed to address the central causes of the problem you are

addressing, based on your own research and experience, and based on previous experiments by others. Scatter-shot approaches to vaguely-defined problems make poor prospects for funding. The project's goals and objectives should be clearly identified and measurable."]

[Dan, who are some local leaders from groups that you work with, both mentoring initiatives and other who would be useful to sign on as secondary partners?]

Lead agency, T/MC with Steve Russos as project director (independently connected or directly connected). While this is consistent with what we've been developing, it goes to much greater depth, faster than we have the current capacity to manage. This proposal must bring the infrastructure support to manage this growth, and I'd need to be able to count on you to bear the operational needs on your shoulders while I continue to manage the T/MC (and Cabrini Connections) around it.

It would be great to connect with another local academic partner who might help develop learning modules, etc.

Local volunteer organizations

Business partners

State/National partners

Others we seek financial, human & in-kind support.